

BACKYARD BIRDS OF NORTH AMERICA

A Coloring & Field Guide Book

Volume 1 • 40 Birds • 120 Coloring Pages

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Volume 1

40 SPECIES • 120 PAGES • EDUCATIONAL & ARTISTIC

Suitable for adults and older children

www.BackyardBirdsBook.com

Backyard Birds of North America — Vol. 1

A Coloring & Field Guide Book

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The coloring illustrations in this book are original artworks created for educational and artistic purposes. All bird data, range descriptions, and natural history information have been compiled from peer-reviewed ornithological sources and reflect the best available knowledge at the time of publication.

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A note on coloring:

Each coloring illustration is printed on a single page with a blank reverse side, so that markers and felt-tip pens will not bleed through onto adjacent content. Colored pencils, watercolor pencils, and fine-tip markers are recommended.

Conservation data sourced from the IUCN Red List and the North American Breeding Bird Survey (BBS). Population estimates are approximate and subject to ongoing revision.

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INTRODUCTION

Welcome to *Backyard Birds of North America — Volume 1*, a coloring and field guide book featuring forty of the most beloved and commonly encountered birds across the continent. This book is designed for anyone who loves birds — whether you are a seasoned birder, a curious beginner, or simply someone who enjoys the meditative practice of coloring.

HOW THIS BOOK IS ORGANIZED

Each bird is presented across three sections: two facing pages of natural history information followed by a full-page coloring illustration. The information pages cover the bird's appearance, habitat and range, diet, behavior, nesting, song, conservation status, and practical tips for attracting it to your garden. A coloring guide at the bottom of the second information page identifies the key plumage zones and suggests colors to use for an accurate rendering.

The coloring illustrations are printed on a single side of the page with a blank reverse, so that felt-tip markers and pens will not bleed through onto the facing text. Colored pencils, watercolor pencils, and fine-tip markers all work beautifully on this paper.

ABOUT THE SPECIES SELECTION

The forty species in this volume were selected to represent the full range of backyard birds encountered across North America — from coast to coast and from the boreal forests of Canada to the subtropical gardens of Florida and the desert Southwest. The selection spans a wide range of families, habitats, and ecological roles, and includes both year-round residents and seasonal visitors. Together they form a portrait of the extraordinary avian diversity that surrounds us every day.

CONSERVATION NOTE

Many of the species featured in this book are in decline. Population trend data from the North American Breeding Bird Survey shows that more than two-thirds of the birds in this volume have experienced measurable population decreases since 1970. The most effective actions any individual can take are simple: plant native trees and shrubs, reduce or eliminate lawn pesticides, keep cats indoors, and place decals on large windows to reduce fatal collisions.

HOW TO USE THE COLORING GUIDE

At the bottom of each bird's second information page you will find a color guide table listing the key plumage zones and a suggested color for each. These suggestions reflect the actual colors of the living bird and are a useful starting point — but feel free to experiment. Many birds show geographic variation in color, and individual birds vary with age, season, and light. There is no single "correct" coloring.

TIPS FOR BEST RESULTS

- **Colored pencils** give the finest detail and are ideal for the intricate feather patterns of woodpeckers, warblers, and sparrows.
- **Watercolor pencils** can be applied dry and then activated with a damp brush for a soft, painterly effect that suits birds like the Hermit Thrush or Cedar Waxwing.
- **Fine-tip markers** produce bold, saturated color ideal for the vivid blues and reds of the Indigo Bunting, Northern Cardinal, or Baltimore Oriole. The blank reverse page means bleed-through is not a concern.
- Work from light colors to dark, and leave white areas untouched rather than coloring them white.

READING THE INFORMATION PAGES

Quick Stats boxes give size, weight, and lifespan data in both imperial and metric units. Population trend data is sourced from the IUCN Red List and the North American Breeding Bird Survey. Page numbers run continuously through the book and correspond to the reference numbers in the Table of Contents.

We hope this book deepens your appreciation for the birds outside your window — and inspires you to make your garden a little more welcoming to them.

— The Editors